Pro Features (Paid)

For an additional monthly fee, Oban offers a robust set of pro features. You don't need these features to build your app, but they are useful once you hit a certain point or have an increased set of needs.

Some of the key pro features[10] include a more powerful execution engine, batched job support, strictly ordered job execution, and fan-in fan-out workflows.

Wrapping Up

If you're building an app, you will eventually need a solution to execute asynchronous jobs. There are many tasks that become simplified when executing them asynchronously, such as delivering emails, syncing data to other systems, or building a data pipeline to process your data. Reach for a job system if a piece of code has a high chance of failure, could be slow due to external factors, or benefits from concurrency.

Elixir provides all of the building blocks you need to write highly parallel systems, so you may be tempted to build your own solution to async jobs. For example, you could use `Task` or `GenServer` to process jobs in an async manner. Unless you have a really good reason not to, use an off-the-shelf library that provides a solid foundation such as controlled concurrency, transactions, and auditing.

Oban is the best job-processing library in the Elixir ecosystem. It's easy to get started with, but it offers many advanced features that let you grow your application over time. The best part about using Oban is that your application will follow best practices that have been laid out by the Oban developers. You'll be making good use of OTP and concurrency without even thinking about it!

The Oban worker you built in this chapter was a simple module that implemented a `perform/1` function. You also added an `enqueue/1` function to make it easy to add jobs to the Oban queue. Oban is backed by Postgres, so you were able to leverage transactions to guarantee that the data and job were inserted at the same time.

Before we wrap up our application, we need to write some tests. The next chapter will take us through tests for our entire application.

10. https://getoban.pro/docs/pro/overview.html